

ACTIVITY 11 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**Work Breakdown Structure and WBS Dictionary**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Workshop	75 minutes	LO1, LO2	3 - Plan the Project

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to state and apply the 100% rule, the single principle that makes a WBS correct or incorrect.

What learners produce

wbs, wbs dictionary, scope baseline — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- The Project Management Templates pack (see the Activities folder)
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 to 4. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group; each group needs one laptop for the calculations.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Confirm the inputs and the boundary. The WBS decomposes the scope statement. Before decomposing, confirm what the boundary is, because the 100% rule is meaningless without a defined 100%.	The trace is the learning, not the artifact. Ask a group to walk one line end to end aloud.
2	Build the WBS to three levels. Create artifacts/11-wbs.md. Render it as an indented tree with numbered codes.	If the room agrees too quickly, take the quietest role aside and give them one more constraint.
3	Trace the compliance workstream to its origin. Branch 1.8 deserves a specific note, because it is the branch most likely to be questioned as overhead.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
4	Write the WBS dictionary. Create artifacts/11-wbs-dictionary.md. A WBS code and a name are not enough to execute work. The dictionary entry is what a person	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.

	who was not in the planning session needs.	
5	Place control accounts and planning packages. Rolling wave: two branches are deliberately left as planning packages at baseline.	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
6	Assemble the scope baseline. Create artifacts/11-scope-baseline.md containing all three components with a version number and an approval block.	Ask which link would break first if the schedule compressed by two weeks.
7	Reconcile the WBS with the product backlog. This is the real hybrid tailoring question, and it is the one most often answered badly - usually by maintaining both artifacts as duplicates and letting them drift apart.	Watch for groups listing only the obvious. Ask what they are deliberately leaving out, and why.
8	Answer the exam-style scenarios	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
8 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
28 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
28 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
11 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 75 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. State and apply the 100% rule, the single principle that makes a WBS correct or incorrect — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Decompose the Contoso scope into a deliverable-oriented WBS to three levels — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Apply the 8/80 rule and the estimate-and-assign test to decide when to stop decomposing — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. Every WBS element is a noun phrase. If any element begins with a verb, it is an activity and belongs in Lab 12 — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would work breakdown structure and wbs dictionary have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- Every WBS element is a noun phrase. If any element begins with a verb, it is an activity and belongs in Lab 12.
- Your WBS contains a project management branch. A WBS with no 1.1 does not include 100% of the work, because managing the project is work that consumes budget.
- Every one of IN-1 to IN-10 maps to a WBS element, and none of OUT-1 to OUT-7 appears anywhere.
- You verified the 100% rule at each level by asking what is left over, not by assuming.
- Your work package efforts sum to SGD 347,980, reconciling to the charter's SGD 348,000 development line. If they do not, Lab 13 will not reconcile either.
- Every dictionary entry has acceptance criteria that someone outside the planning session could apply without asking a question.

- You can state the three components of the scope baseline without hesitating, and explain why the WBS alone is insufficient.
- You have at least one planning package, and you can explain why decomposing it now would produce detail rather than accuracy.